

INTERVIEW GUIDE FOR ROLE-PLAY AI CHATBOT STUDY

Introduction

Thank you for participating in this interview. And I do a short introduction for myself. I'm a PhD student of [university name]. In our previous emails I have sent you the explanatory statement and informed consent form which you have signed and returned to me, indicating that you have read the entire document and agree to participate in this interview. This online interview will be conducted just between you and me. It will take approximately 40 minutes to one hour. During the meeting you could choose to keep your camera on or off. I will record the audio and take some notes during the interview, but I won't record any video. Your thoughts and experiences are important to us. You are free to ask questions or choose not to answer certain questions at any time. I want to emphasize that there is no right or wrong answer. We only want to learn about your personal experiences. So if you are all good with this, we could just get started.

Usage Pattern / Background Questions

- What RACs have you used before?
- When did you start using [Specific RAC]?
- Why did you start to use it?
- How often do you use it?
- For how long do you tend to use [Specific RAC] each time (a range in minutes is fine)?
- Where are you usually when you use it?
- What prompts or motivates you to use [Specific RAC]?
- With what AI characters do you usually interact?
- Do you have a favourite, or how do you decide which ones to interact with?

Mood and Emotional Impact

- How do you think [Specific RAC] affects your mood or emotions?
- Can you give me some examples of when you most noticed this?
- Are there situations in which using [Specific RAC] has improved your mood? Can you say more about this/give me some examples?

- Are there situations in which using [Specific RAC] has lowered your mood? Can you say more about this/give me some examples?
- Why do you think this might have happened?
- Is your mood only usually affected for a short time - while using [Specific RAC] - or for longer? Can you please explain?
- Apart from feeling happy or sad, does using [Specific RAC] ever make you feel any other emotions? Can you please explain?
- Do any specific AI characters affect your mood more than others? If so, which? And tell me more about how?
- Do you think using [Specific RAC] affects your mood in a similar or different way to other people (real persons)? Could you please explain why?

Life and Relationships

- Since using [Specific RAC], have you noticed any changes—if any—in your relationships with family, friends, or others? If so, please describe the changes (positive or negative) and give examples.

Privacy Impact

- When using [Specific RAC], how—if at all—does it influence what you choose to share about yourself?
- When you use [Specific RAC], does your mood affect what you choose to disclose? If so, how?
- Thinking back on your interactions with [Specific RAC], have you ever reconsidered something you shared? If so, could you describe the situation?
- Compared with other generative AI (e.g., ChatGPT), does interacting with role-play chatbots change your willingness to express feelings or share personal information? If so, what factors influence that?

Closing

- Can you think of any other ways in which [Specific RAC] might have affected your mood?
- Is there anything you would like AI developers to know about how [Specific RAC] affects your mood or how it could be more helpful for managing your mood?